

What is Rhetoric?

- ☐ Rhetoric is “**the planned use of symbols to achieve goals.**”
- ☐ Most rhetoric is **carefully planned**, not spontaneous.
- ☐ **Rhêtorikê – art or skill of**
- ☐ Seeks to affect the free choices of groups or individuals (i.e. not coercion or violence as that limits choices)
- ☐ Symbols:
 - ☐ Written and spoken language
 - ☐ Nonverbal behaviors
 - ☐ Fine arts (paintings, drawings, sculptures)
 - ☐ Music
 - ☐ Visual images (photographs, films, TV programs)
 - ☐ The goal is to **influence an audience**, often to change thoughts or behaviors.

Rhetoric has an external address – address others:

- ✓ Adapting reasons to reflect shared values.
- ✓ rhetors’ statements will reflect the social norms of a particular group, times and places (context!).
- ✓ You must give reasons to justify your views and explain your positions.
- ✓ Need to examine the use of symbols by people and what they mean

7 Ps of Rhetoric

1. **Public:** addressed to others/deals with issues and problems that one person alone cannot solve
2. **Propositional:** Developed through complete thoughts/One person’s ideas must be understandable so that others can cooperate and debate
3. **Purposive:** Trying to achieve a particular goal
4. **Problem Solving:** Often is valuable in situations with a felt need such as: Closure, Beginnings, Memorializing, Social issues
5. **Pragmatic:** Connecting to the idea of praxis / that which is practical; Looking for solutions that can be put into effect or enacted
6. **Poetic:** Appeals to the senses
7. **Powerful:** Has the potential to move individuals to participate, change minds, alter perceptions

Rhetorical perspective

- orientations or attitudes that frame the way we think
- emphasis on and it concerns with the resources available in language and in people to:
 - Make ideas clear and cogent
 - Bring concepts to life

- Make them salient for people
- Interested in what influences or persuades people
- Focuses on the types of issues upon which informed and honest people can disagree because the emphasis is arriving at social truths

Social truth

- Created and tested by groups of people
- Influence social and political decisions
- Represent what a group of people agrees to believe or accept
- Can be seen as “common sense”

Rhetorical acts:

- An intention, created, polished attempt to overcome the challenges in a given situation with a specific audience on a given issues to achieve a particular end
- Creates a message whose shape and form, beginning and end, are stamped on it by one or more human authors with goals for an audience

Rhetorical purposes:

- Rhetors uses ideas, pictures, and experiences when addressing an audience
- The most basic kind of influence (communicating) requires you to initiate a rhetorical act that can be translated into virtual (i.e. not being personally) experience by others
- You can also alter an audience’s perception by providing a new frame of reference for understanding situations and events (example – *Oliver Twist*)
- Explanation – rhetoric can be used to provide a perspective on situations that are outside of our general understanding, intense, and may seem irrational
- Formulating belief – when perceptions change, we seek explanations. As this proceeds, we may formulate a new belief or discard an old one for another
- Initiating action – In order to encourage action, the new belief must be reinforced, rendered salient, and then channeled so that the action seems appropriate, possible, and necessary
- Maintaining action – reinforcement as a commitment to a cause; we can see this in the many rituals we have in our societies Module

INVENTION

- Comes from the Latin word *Invenire*
- The first part of Rhetoric
- Rhetors adapt existing ideas and materials they find in:
 - Their research
 - Their training
 - In other speeches and essays
 - In the culture around them

WHAT IS INVENTION?

- “Invention is the discovery of valid or seemingly valid arguments to render one’s cause plausible.” -Cicero

STATIS THEORY

FINDING YOUR ARGUMENT

STASIS 1: THE FACTS / CONJECTURE:

- Is there a problem or issue?
- What changed to create the problem/issue?
- What happened to bring attention to the issue/problem?
- How did it begin and what are its causes?
- What are the facts surrounding the issue/problem?
- Can the issue/problem be changed?
- Ask critical questions of your own research and conclusions:
- Where was the data obtained and are these sources reliable?
- Why are the sources reliable?

STASIS 2: DEFINITION:

- What is the nature of the problem/issue?
- What exactly is the problem/issue?
- What kind of a problem/issue is it?
- To what larger class of things or events does it belong?
- What are its parts, and how are they related?
- It may also be useful to ask critical questions of your own research and conclusions:
 - Who/what is influencing our definition of this problem/issue?
 - How/why are these sources/beliefs influencing our definition?

STASIS 3: QUALITY:

- Is it a good thing or a bad thing?
- How serious is the problem/issue?
- Whom might it affect (stakeholders)?
- What happens if we don't do anything?
- What are the costs of solving the problem/issue?
- It may also be useful to ask critical questions of your own research and conclusions:
 - Who/what is influencing our determination of the seriousness of this problem/issue?
 - How/why are these sources/beliefs influencing our determination?

STASIS 4: POLICY

- Should action be taken?

- Who should be involved in helping to solve the problem/address the issue?
- What should be done about this problem?
- What needs to happen to solve this problem/address this issue?
- It may also be useful to ask critical questions of your own research and conclusions:
- Who/what is influencing our determination of what to do about this problem/issue?
- How/why are these sources/beliefs influencing our determination?

HOW DOES STATIS THEORY HELP YOU?

- Clarifies your thinking about the point in dispute/discussion
- Forces you to think about the assumptions and values shared by members of your audience
- Demonstrates when more research needs to be done
- Suggests which proofs (Ethos, Pathos, or Logos) are most import to your writing or speaking
- May help improve your Arrangement (organization)

APPLYING STATIS THEORY

TOPIC: PERMITTING SOCIAL MEDIA USAGE FOR PEOPLE UNDER THE AGE OF 18

FACT: WHAT IS HAPPENING?

Did something happen?	Have social media platforms become widely used by people under 18, and has this raised measurable concerns?
What are the facts?	what correlations exist with mental health, sleep, academic performance, or social relationships?
Causes and changes:	How did this pattern of use develop and what changes distinguish current use from earlier internet use?
Can it be changed?	Are there documented cases where changes in design, policy, or parenting practices reduced harmful patterns of use?

DEFINITION: WHAT KIND OF ISSUE IS IT?

What exactly is the issue:	Is it “any social media use under 18,” “excessive social media use,” or “unsupervised access to certain platforms”?
What kind of issue:	Is it primarily a public health issue, an education issue, a child-safety issue, or a technology-design issue?
Larger class:	Does it belong to the broader class of “digital media exposure in childhood,” “addictivedesign of technologies,” or “youth risk behaviors online”?
Parts and relations:	Break the issue into sub-issues such as (1) mental health, (2) cognitive/academic impact, (3) privacy and data collection, (4) exposure to harmful content, and (5) social development

QUALITY: HOW SERIOUS? HOW GOOD OR BAD?

Good/Bad:	What benefits does social media provide to minors and what harms are credibly documented?
Seriousness:	How widespread and severe are the harms relative to the benefits, and do the harms disproportionately affect certain groups?
Stakeholders:	Minors themselves, parents/guardians, schools, mental health professionals, platform companies, regulators, and advertisers all have different stakes
Costs of addressing it:	What are the financial, social, and ethical costs of stricter regulations or restrictions?
Consequences of Inaction	What happens if policies and practices do not change—do we see escalating harms, normalization of surveillance, or growing digital inequities?

POLICY: WHAT SHOULD BE DONE?

Should action be taken:	Do the established facts and your evaluation of seriousness justify intervention, and at what level?
Who should act:	Possible actors include parents, schools, platforms, professional organizations, and lawmakers.
What actions:	Options range from soft measures (education) to stronger measures (age verification).
What needs to happen:	Specify steps like (1) more longitudinal research to refine the fact base, (2) consensus building around a precise definition of “harmful use,” and (3) pilot policies in schools or regions to test impacts before broad adoption

STYLE

ATTEMPTS TO DEFINE STYLE

- Eloquence
- Grammar
- Voice
- Form

STYLE AS MEANING-MAKING

- Specific decisions contributing to development of an idea
- Part of the discovery and composition process
- Use tools to heighten and sharpen your argument and writing

RHETORICAL DEVICES

ANALYSIS OF READING

CREATING LAYERS OF MEANING

- **APORIA:**
 - I'm not sure whether humanity will master technology, or whether technology will master us.
- **ANAPHORA:**
 - To everything there is a season, and a time and purpose under heaven: A time to be born, and a time to die, a time, and a time to pluck up that which is planted...
- **EPISTROPHE**
 - When I was a child, I spoke as a child, I understood as a child, but when I became a man, I put away childish things.
- **SYMPLOCE**
 - When there is talk of hatred, let us stand against it. When there is talk of violence, let us stand against it.
- **AMPLIFICATION**
 - She was a good leader-good because she listened, good because she cared, good because she acted when others hesitated.
- **PERSONIFICATION**
 - The wind whispered secrets through the trees.
- **PARATAxis**
 - I came, I saw, I conquered.

RHETORICAL DEVICES

STRATEGY

ADDING DEPTH

1. Hyperbole: I've explained this a million times.
2. Understatement: Starting my paper at 23:00 was not my best decision.
3. Litotes: This article is not without flaws.
4. Rhetorical Question: Do you think ignoring the data will make the problem go away?
5. Hypophora: What is plagiarism? It's using someone else's words or ideas without giving them proper credit.
6. Procatleipsis: You might say this takes too much class time, but in fact it saves time later because students draft more effectively.
7. Distinctio: By 'revision,' I don't mean simple editing; I mean rethinking your ideas and structure.
8. Antithesis: That's one small step for man, one giant leap for mankind.

ADDING MEANING

1. Simile: Her explanation was like a clear roadmap.
2. Metaphor: This classroom is a laboratory for new ideas.
3. Analogy: Writing a research paper is like building a bridge: you need a strong design, solid support, and careful testing before people can safely use it.
4. Allusion: Without clear definitions, your argument can sink faster than the Titanic.
5. Eponym: That solution was truly Einstein-level.
6. Sententia: As the saying goes, “measure twice, cut once”.
7. Exemplum

ORGANIZATION

DESIGN CHOICES

1. Climax: We must protect our campus, our city, and ultimately, our shared future.
2. Parallelism: They came to learn, they stayed to question, they left ready to change things.
3. Anadiplosis: Good feedback builds confidence; confidence leads to risk-taking; risk-taking often leads to real discovery.
4. Metabasis: So far, I’ve explained why accessibility matters; now, I want to show you how we can actually build it into our designs.
5. Parenthesis: The new policy-though it arrived without much explanation-will affect every student in this program.
6. Apostrophe: Data, why do you always reveal the exact opposite of what we hoped to find?
7. Enumeratio: To finish this project, we need clear roles, realistic deadlines, steady communication, and honest feedback.
8. Antanagoge: This redesign will require extra work now, but it will save us countless hours of fixes later.

ARRANGEMENT

What is Arrangement?

- Deciding the order of your argument in spoken or written language
- Without a structure your audience recognizes, they will a more difficult time understanding you
- Arrangement also includes:
 - Transitions
 - Moving between points and paragraphs
 - Telling your audience where you have been and where you are going
 - Supporting evidence

Cicero – On Invention

Cicero –

- Roman noble in late roman empire 106 to 43 BCE
- Orator, stateman, philosopher, scholar
- Reportedly wrote *On Invention* at the age of 14 or 16 years old
- The structure presented here was associated with legal or forensic rhetoric
 - Exordium (Introduction)
 - Narratio (Statement of the issue)
 - Partitio (Division of the issue)
 - Confirmatio (Strongest arguments)
 - Refutatio (Arguments anticipated and refuted)
 - Peroratio (conclusion)

Exordium

- Meaning
 - Latin – To urge forward
 - Similar to the English word “to exhort” or to urge earnestly
- This section was important as the speaker or writer used this section to establish their ethos as intelligent and trustworthy individuals
- Your style or need was determined by the type of “case” you had
 - Honorable
 - Has immediate support from the audience
 - Difficult
 - Audience is lacking in sympathy to either the writer/speaker or the issue
 - Mean
 - Audience considers the issue or the writer/speaker as unimportant or uninteresting
 - Ambiguous
 - The Audience is unsure about what the issue is, or the issue is somewhat honorable and somewhat difficult
 - Obscure
 - The issue is too difficult for the audience to understand, because they are uninformed or because it is too complex
- 2 types of exordium
 - Introduction
 - Direct
 - Audience is receptive and engaged
 - Using plain language

- Can be used with mean, ambiguous, or obscure cases as the audience is primarily confused and not hostile
- Insinuation
 - Indirect
 - “steal into the mind”

Narratio (Background)

- states the issue as clearly and simply as she can
 - You should favor your own position when stating the facts
 - If your audience is very familiar with a topic, you may need a very limited narratio
- Who, what, where, when, and why. Only what is useful
- Define key terms
- Defend uncommon definitions and uses

Partitio (Division)

- Goals:
 - Name the issues that will be discussed or debated in your writing or speech
 - Listing the arguments in the order they will appear in your work
- Value to audience:
 - Acknowledges which issues need to be addressed by all parties
 - Announcing the order in which the arguments appear makes it easier for your audience to follow
 - Adds to the overall *ethos* of the speaker/writer because you will seem both intelligent and thoughtful towards your audience

Conformatio & Refutatio

- Confirmation
 - Offering logos (logic) as proof for your arguments
 - This is the main body of your work
 - You are attempting to support your position
- Refutation
 - Might be necessary for a rhetor to anticipate arguments that might damage their *ethos* /case if the audience accepts them
 - Therefore, it is important to anticipate how your ideas might get attacked
 - Ways to refute:
 - Deny the premise
 - Question an example given that counters your argument
 - Provide counter arguments

Peroration (Conclusion)

According to Cicero, there are 3 ways to conclude:

- Summarize
 - review issues
 - recall how each issue was supported
- Make an appeal to emotion (pathos)
 - invoke authority
 - point out effects
 - show what happens if state of affairs unchanged
 - point out effects elsewhere
 - show that decision can't be reversed
 - show whether state of affairs is intentional or accidental
 - arouse anger at opponents
 - demonstrate that state of affairs violates community values
 - compare/contrast state of affairs with similar one
 - paint vivid picture of effects
 - imply ignorance in opponents
- Enhance Ethos
 - show how state of affairs has deteriorated
 - show that state of affairs will continue
 - show audience how they are harmed by state of affairs
 - paint vivid pictures of current misery
 - show how state of affairs causes people to behave badly

MEMORY

SEIZING THE MOMENT-KAIROS

- Time
- Chronos
- Linear Time
- Kairos
- Situation
- Season

ANCIENT MEMORY SYSTEMS

- “Artificial Memory”
 - Careful training
 - Memory palaces

- Dissoi Logi
 - Focus
 - Practice
 - Connect

MODERN VERSIONS OF ANCIENT MEMORY SYSTEMS

- Cultural Memory
- Organizational Memory
- Literate Memory Systems

DELIVERY-Hypokrisis (Greek)/ Actio (Latin)

CONSIDERATIONS FOR SPOKEN DELIVERY

Nonverbal

- Appearance
- Facial expression
- Posture
- Gestures
- Eye contact
- Movement

Verbal

- Rate
- Volume
- Pitch
- Enunciation
- Dramatic pause

CONSIDERATIONS FOR WRITTEN DELIVERY

- Forms of academic writing
- Rules of correctness
- Textual presentation
- Visual presentation

Topic:

- Your own angle of vision
- A viewpoint
- Guidelines for choosing your essay topic:
 - Begin with something you know and can talk about
 - Say a lot about a little rather than a little about a lot
 - Narrow the topic until you can express a definite position

Purpose:

- Each writing situation has a specific goal
- In order to achieve your goal, you will need to have a strategy
- Purpose statement – what you want to do with your writing
- Guidelines for deciding on your writing purpose:
 - Specify your goal
 - Identify an effective strategy
 - Take your time

Thesis:

- Announces what you want to say with your writing
- You are describing the big picture in one or two sentences
- It should appear early in your writing (introductory paragraph) to provide a framework for your writing and your audience
- It must contain:
 - The topic
 - Your viewpoint about the topic
- Depending upon the type of writing you are doing, it can be expressed as a/an:
 - Opinion
 - Evaluation
 - Suggestion
 - Question
 - Debatable claim
- Questions to evaluate your thesis:
 - What, exactly, is your point, and why is it worth reading about?
 - Is the topic sharply focused?
 - Is a definite viewpoint expressed?
 - Is the viewpoint worthwhile?
 - Is the point supportable?
 - Does the thesis offer a preview of where the essay is headed?

Audience:

- They need enough material to understand your position and to react appropriately
- Don't need a repletion of material they already know
- Guidelines for analyzing your audience:
 - Picture your readers and exactly what they need and expect
 - When you don't know exactly who will be reading your essay, picture the 'general reader'
 - Anticipate your readers' questions
 - Anticipate your readers' reactions

Freewriting:

- Write whatever comes to mind
- The act of recording your thinking can help generate useful content

Questions Journalists Ask:

- Who was involved?
- What happened?
- When did it happen?
- Where did it happen?
- How did it happen?
- Why did it happen?

Brainstorming:

- A way to produce as many ideas as possible
- Guidelines for brainstorming:
 - Find a quiet spot, something to write with, and a timer
 - Set timer for 30 minutes

- Avoid interruptions
- Concentrate on your writing situation
- Start writing down all ideas you think of – all of them. Don't judge them
- Write for as long as you can – if you still have ideas and the alarm has gone off, keep going
- Take a break and step away from the list
- Go back to your list and now go through the list with a fresh a perspective

Organizing and Selecting Research:

- Pick only the best material that supports your meaning
- Guidelines for selecting and organizing material:
 - Never expect to use everything
 - Organize logically
 - Introduction – orientation for your reader
 - Middle – reveals your exact meaning
 - Ending – emphasizes what is most important and leaves audience reflecting upon what they have read
 - Check your outline for unity
 - Check your outline for emphasis

Antithesis:

- Contrary or contradictory ideas are expressed in phrases that are grammatically alike

4 Qualities of Persuasive Style:

- Correctness
 - Rhetors should use words that were current
 - Should adhere to the grammatical rules of the language in which they were writing
- Clarity
 - a/k/a Perspicuity
 - Use words in their ordinary, usual, or everyday senses unless there is a compelling reason to do otherwise
 - Can lose clarity through the use of words that are:
 - Obsolete
 - Technical
 - New
 - Colloquial
- Appropriateness
 - To say or do whatever is fitting in a give situation
- Ornament
 - Uses of language
 - Included:
 - Figures of speech
 - Figures of thought
 - Tropes

Rhetorical question:

- A rhetor asks a question to which they really don't expect an answer
- Opens an opportunity to say more things

Onomatopoeia:

- Assigns a new word to a thing which either lacks a name or has an inappropriate name

Antonomasia:

- Substitute a descriptive phrase for someone's proper name or vice versa

Metonymy:

- Names something with a word or phrase closely associated with it

Periphrasis:

- Rather than expressing an idea in the most brief way possible, expanding it in order to ornament it

Hyperbaton:

- Transposing a word to somewhere other than its usual place in a sentence/word order

Synecdoche:

- Substitute the part for the whole (or vice versa) or cause for effect (or vice versa)

Catachresis:

The incorrect/inexact use of a similar word in the place of a better, more precise one